Digital Literacy Project

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Course: Digital Literacy (CSE0001)

INTRODUCTION

This project is based on the concept of digital literacy, which is an essential skill in today's modern world. As a student, it is important to understand how to use digital tools effectively, communicate professionally online, and stay safe on the internet.

In this project, I have completed five different tasks that helped me explore various aspects of digital literacy. These tasks include creating an infographic, building a digital portfolio, exploring online platforms, learning email etiquette, and understanding cybercrime awareness.

The main aim of this project is to improve my digital skills and learn how to use online platforms responsibly and effectively. Through this project, I gained practical knowledge and hands-on experience with different digital tools that will be useful in my academic and professional journey.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using Canva, which is a simple and user-friendly online design tool. The purpose of this infographic is to spread awareness among students about the importance of digital literacy in today's digital world.

In my design, I included key topics such as the meaning of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students like Google Docs and Canva, and important safe internet practices such as using strong passwords and avoiding suspicious links. I also added a section on email etiquette to guide students on how to communicate professionally online.

While creating the infographic, I focused on making it visually attractive and easy to understand by using icons, colors, and short points instead of long paragraphs. Canva provided many templates which made designing easier, but selecting the best layout and organizing all information in one page was a bit challenging.

Overall, this task helped me improve my creativity and understand how to present important information in a clear and engaging way.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created my student digital portfolio by setting up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms are important for building a professional online presence and showcasing skills to future employers.

GitHub is mainly used for sharing code and projects. I created a profile README that includes my name, branch, and learning goals. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I added my education details, including my current degree and university. Kaggle is a platform for data science and machine learning, where users can learn, practice, and participate in competitions.

These platforms will be very useful for my future career. Over the next four years, I plan to regularly update my GitHub with projects, connect with professionals on LinkedIn, and improve my skills through Kaggle competitions and courses. This will help me build a strong digital presence and improve my chances of getting internships and job opportunities.

Task 3: Explore Coding and Collaboration Platforms

For Task 3, I explored both a coding practice platform and a collaboration tool. I used HackerRank to practice basic programming skills and completed a beginner-level problem. This helped me understand how coding platforms work and how they can improve logical thinking and problem-solving abilities.

In addition, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The form consisted of five questions, including multiple choice and short answer types, covering topics such as digital literacy, safe internet practices, and professional platforms. I also viewed the responses in Google Sheets to understand how data is collected and analyzed.

These platforms are very useful for academic growth. Hacker Rank helps in improving coding skills, which are essential for technical interviews, while Google Forms is helpful for conducting surveys, quizzes, and collecting feedback efficiently. Overall, this task helped me gain practical exposure to important digital tools that I can use throughout my academic journey.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

In today's digital world, effective communication plays a very important role in both academic and professional environments. Poor digital communication can often lead to misunderstandings and missed opportunities. For instance, a student once sent an email to a professor without including a proper subject line or greeting. The email was written in an informal tone and did not clearly explain the purpose. As a result, the professor did not respond on time, and the student missed an important deadline.

This situation shows the importance of following proper email etiquette. A professional email should always include a clear subject line, polite greeting, structured body, and a proper closing. These elements help in conveying the message clearly and respectfully.

To avoid such issues, students should always communicate in a formal and respectful manner. Using correct formatting, maintaining clarity, and being polite can make communication more effective. This task helped me understand how to write professional emails and the importance of responsible communication in the digital world.

Task 5: Reflection on Cybercrime Awareness (UPI Fraud)

While working on the UPI fraud case study, I realized how rapidly cybercrimes are increasing with the growth of digital payments. I was particularly surprised to learn how easily fraudsters can manipulate users through fake calls, messages, and QR codes. Even a small mistake, such as clicking on an unknown link or entering a UPI PIN without proper verification, can lead to instant financial loss. Many people are still unaware that a UPI PIN is only required for sending money and not for receiving it, which makes them easy targets.

This task helped me understand the importance of digital literacy and being cautious while using online payment platforms. I learned that users must always verify the authenticity of requests, avoid suspicious links, and protect their personal and banking information. As a result, I will be more careful while making digital transactions and will never share my UPI PIN or OTP with anyone. I will also spread awareness among my friends and family so that they can stay safe from such cybercrimes in the future.

Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project helped me understand the importance of using digital tools responsibly and effectively in today's world. Through the different tasks, I learned how to create a professional online presence, communicate properly through emails, and use platforms like GitHub and Google Forms for academic purposes. I also gained practical knowledge about coding platforms and collaboration tools.

One of the most important learnings from this project was awareness about cybercrime and online safety. I understood how small mistakes can lead to serious consequences and why it is important to stay alert while using digital platforms. Overall, this project improved my digital skills, confidence, and awareness. It will help me in my academic journey and also in building a strong professional profile in the future.

References

- **Canva (https://www.canva.com)**
- **GitHub (https://github.com)**
- **LinkedIn (https://www.linkedin.com)**
- **Kaggle (https://www.kaggle.com)**
- **Google Forms (https://forms.google.com)**
- **HackerRank (https://www.hackerrank.com)**
- **Cyber Crime Portal (https://cybercrime.gov.in)**